

What is the best way to read the Psalter?

A letter from Priest Seraphim. 15th Sunday after Pentecost. Sep 12/25, 2022

http://www.orthodox.net/letters/letter_2022-09-25+15h-sun-after-pentecost+how-to-read-the-psalter.docx

http://www.orthodox.net/letters/letter_2022-09-25+15h-sun-after-pentecost+how-to-read-the-psalter.pdf

I mention reading the Psalter in at least 50% of my sermons. The Psalter is the prayer book of the church, and not only do we read it all the way through in our services verbatim every week, but we use parts of it in all of the services, and all of our prayers are influenced by the style of the prayers of the Psalter.

It is quite impossible to have the “phronema” of the church without reading the Psalter and loving it, or at least praying and thinking in the way of the Psalter. The literal meaning of the word phronema is: "mind", "spirit", "thought", "purpose", "will". It means, basically, the “mind of the church.” This encompasses everything about who we are and all that it is in concordance with who God is. It encompasses our thoughts, feelings, desires, how we live, how we react to everything, our prayer, and the acquiring of the virtues. The mind of the church is what we are trying to acquire.

If we have the mind of the church, since the church is the body of Christ, we have the mind of Christ. And this is what we are trying to obtain. After all, the purpose of life is to know God: “And this is Eternal life, that they may know Thee, the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom Thou hast sent (John 17:3).” We cannot know someone without becoming like them, and certainly if we acquire the mind of Christ, we will be like Him and know Him. Our feeble minds know very little about God. God reveals himself to everyone, and we can see that when man interprets God according to his own mind, there is idolatry and heresy. Every culture believes in “God” in some way because God

has revealed himself to everyone; however, He will only reveal Himself according to Who He is to those who are struggling to be like Him.

Reading the Psalter attentively will help us to acquire the proper phronema. Therefore, the first proper way to read the Psalter is to *read it with the intent of becoming like God and changing the dark parts of ourselves into light and the cold parts of ourselves into fire*. Of course, none of this is possible without the grace of God, and it is not an intellectual exercise; however, God has given us the ability to understand language, and reading with attention compunctionate and aggressive language will help us very much to change. We must learn to live life *aggressively* because the Lord teaches that the kingdom of heaven is being won by violence.¹ This violence is against sin and for virtue. Everything we do should be aggressive and with intent. This is not the aggression of the world. This is the aggression of the one who hates sin in himself and is striving to know Jesus Christ intimately. The attentive person who prays the Psalter will understand that every human condition, passion, and predicament is described with the (aggressive) solution — reading the Psalter teaches us how to pray and think.

It is very profitable to look at how the church reads the Psalter and let our reading correspond to this. The church is very careful to read the entire Psalter all the way through every week. If one were to go to all of the services of the church in a given week as they are celebrated in monasteries that are observing the full

order of services, in Vespers and Matins, the entire Psalter will be read in the course of the week, in addition to large numbers of Psalms that are read in various services regularly, such as three Psalms in 1st, 3rd, 6th and 9th hour and Compline, and several Psalms in Matins and Vespers, and most Divine Liturgies, several Psalms.

The Christian week begins on Sunday, and according to our reckoning, which is similar to the Jewish reckoning, we consider the day to start with sunset. Therefore, Vespers on Saturday night is the beginning of Sunday, the first day of the week, and therefore includes reading the first Kathisma of the Psalter (Psalms 1-8). Sunday morning Matins includes another two Kathismas, two and three. And we continue throughout the week reading the Psalter in sequence. Since there are 20 Kathismas in the Psalter, reading 3 Kathismas daily would total 21. Therefore, on Sunday evening at Vespers, we take a little break and do not read a kathisma. If you do the math, you will see that reading two Kathismas on Sunday and three on all of the other days (1 at Vespers, two at matins) will total 20 Kathismas, all 150 psalms in the Psalter.

Let's explain how the Psalter is divided. The word Kathisma means "not standing." It is traditional that when the Psalter is read in the church, everyone can sit down. Reading each of these Kathismas can be somewhat long, perhaps ten or even 15 minutes. It is good to have a rest during this time of reading. Each Kathisma is separated into three sections, each called a "stasis." Each Kathisma has a varying number of Psalms based on how long the Psalms are. There is even one Kathisma of the Psalter, number 17, which includes only one Psalm (Psalm 118, which is 176 verses!) It doesn't matter if you remember this terminology very well; just think of the Psalter as having 20 chapters, each having three subchapters.

This brings me to another suggestion for how to read the Psalter properly. Don't read it from a regular Bible! *Read it from a proper, Orthodox liturgical Psalter.* First of all, a regular Bible will likely not be from the Septuagint. All of the beautiful theological and Christological imagery of the terms in the Psalter is preserved if we read a good Psalter translated from the Septuagint. The Septuagint is a Greek translation of the Scriptures from 70 Hebrew scholars, about 300 years before Christ. It is considered to be the normative version of the Scriptures. All other ancient interpretations of the Scripture are tainted because Jewish scholars tried to remove messianic (about Jesus Christ) imagery, prophecies, and theology.

I recommend that you *read the Psalter from a very good translation.* We use the so-called "Boston" translation. It is very dear to me because I have memorized many psalms. There is another very good translation that Jordanville Monastery is publishing (I believe they call it a "Psalter for Prayer," and it is in their pocket prayer book.) Either Psalter is great to use; however, if one is in our church and wants to be familiar with what we are saying, I recommend the Boston Psalter. It is also very convenient to buy the smaller version of this Psalter, a little green book I carry everywhere.

My third suggestion about reading the Psalter properly is to try to *read the entire Psalter!* I think it's better to read systematically. Since we cannot easily read three Kathismas every day exactly as the church does in its daily services, the way I read the Psalter is, to begin with, the first kathisma and read it. If I have time, I read another one and another. Wherever I stop, I start reading the next day. I prefer to read in chunks of Kathismas. You might read psalm by psalm or stasis by stasis. It doesn't matter. If you have the endurance, it's good to read a full Kathisma or even two. If this is very difficult for you, then read one or two psalms and put your bookmark in the book, and then start from

there the next time. It is much more important to read each psalm as attentively as you know how rather than read many psalms.

When we read a Kathisma in the church, we say short prayers after each stasis. You may want to do this. I do it sometimes. Sometimes I don't want to get caught up in all the details, and I just want to say the

Psalms. Other times I say the Psalter in a more "formal" way and even do prostrations with the prayers. The most important consideration when praying the Psalms at home is to pray with your heart, not necessarily follow the exact way they are read in the church. Below are prayers that are after each stasis. They are very simple, and this sequence of prayers is repeated in many other parts of our services.

After each stasis, say the following prayers with bows or prostrations.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Amen. *(bow or prostration)*

Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia, glory to Thee our God *(bow or prostration)*

Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia, glory to Thee our God *(bow or prostration)*

Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia, glory to Thee our God *(bow or prostration)*

Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy. *(bow or prostration)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever and to the ages of ages,

Amen. *(bow or prostration)*

By all means, *if you have favorite Psalms, you could read them every day!* I often read the six Psalms, a collection of, you guessed it, six Psalms that are read early in the matins service, before I read a Kathisma.

I recommend that everyone begin reading the Psalter by saying the "Trisagion prayers," followed by the "O Come Let us worship..." sequence, then Psalm 50 and the Symbol of faith. All of this is explained below.

It is very good to do prostrations or bows with these prayers. When we make a "bow," we make the sign of the cross, and as we are doing it, we bow from the waist as deeply as we wish. A prostration is when we make the sign of the cross, and as we do this, we get to our knees, touch our head to or near the floor, and then stand back up. It is impossible to overestimate the power of prostrations and how much they help our prayer and compunction. They can be

difficult, especially if we are tired or out of shape, but they are amazing!

It is good to do bows if a person cannot do prostrations. If they need to help themselves to do a prostration by using a chair, that's just fine. This is not calisthenics; it is prayer. However, you will find that if you do prostrations regularly, you will feel physically great.

I like very much to do prostrations when I say the "Trisagion" prayers. These are the prayers that begin most prayer rules, including morning and evening prayers, prayers before in preparation for Holy Communion, Compline, and many other places. They are called the Trisagion prayers because they include the "Trisagion" (definition: "thrice holy," from the Greek words "tri" – three, and Agios – holy). The Trisagion is the short prayer, beginning with "Holy God...", which we repeat three times, with the sign of the cross and a bow (or prostration).

The typical “Trisagion prayers” begin with the prayer ‘O Heavenly King...’ (a nuance that you may not need to remember is that the first time we say the Trisagion prayers in a rule of prayer, we usually include “O Heavenly King,” but if we say the Trisagion prayer more times in our rule, we omit “ O Heavenly King.”) If that’s too complicated, then forget I said it. It’s only important that the reader understands this). The Trisagion prayers always end with the “Our Father.” By the way, we often refer to prayers by their first few words. During each prayer, it is good to make the sign of the cross and a bow or even with a prostration. I find that when I do prostrations during these prayers, it slows me down, and I think more about them.

I say the prayer “O heavenly King, “which of course is to the Holy Spirit, in seven different sections with seven prostrations. I do this because it seems right to me because there are seven gifts of the Holy Spirit. (“And there shall come forth a rod out of the root of Jesse, and a blossom shall come up from his root: and the Spirit of God shall rest upon him, the spirit of (1)wisdom and (2)understanding, the spirit of

(3)counsel and (4)strength, the spirit of (5)knowledge and (6)godliness shall fill him; the spirit of the (7)fear of God.” Isa 11:1-3 and (there are nine here, but who is counting) “But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, gentleness, goodness, faith, Meekness, temperance: against such there is no law.” Gal 5:22-23.)

There is nothing dogmatic about this. It’s just kind of my thing. If you want to do this, may God bless you, or if you want to make the sign of the cross when you say each of these prayers, may God bless you! If you want to do prostrations for some or all of the prayers, it is very good to do them.

These prayers are very familiar to us, and we say them often every day. It is essential that the things we do often do not become commonplace. The reason we say these prayers so often is because they are immensely beautiful, theological, and compunctionate. We must try to say them in a way that is worthy of them. We shouldn’t just rattle them off. I find that when I do bows or prostrations, it slows me down, and I pray the prayers more compunctionately.

This is how I do that Trisagion prayers in my morning rule. If you want to do prostrations, may God bless you, and if you want to do bows, may God bless you! And if you don’t want to do bows or prostrations, make the sign of the cross with each prayer that is reminiscent of the Holy Trinity (all of them except “O Heavenly King” and “Our Father”), and may God bless you!

O Heavenly King (*prostration or bow*)

,Comforter (*prostration*)

,Spirit of Truth (*prostration*)

, Who art everywhere present and fillest all things (*prostration*)

, Treasury of good things and Giver of life: (*prostration*)

Come and dwell in us, and cleanse us of all impurity (*prostration*)

,and save our souls, O Good One. (*prostration*)

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us. (*prostration*)

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us. (*prostration*)

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us. *(prostration)*

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.
Amen. *(prostration)*

O Most Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. *(prostration)*

O Lord, blot out our sins. *(prostration)*

O Master, pardon our iniquities. *(prostration)*

O Holy One, visit and heal our infirmities for Thy name's sake. *(prostration)*

Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy. Lord, have mercy. *(prostration)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever and to the ages of ages, Amen.
(prostration)

Our Father, Who art in the Heavens, hallowed be Thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is in Heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

Here a priest will say the exclamation: "For Thine is the Kingdom..."

But when anyone else prays, they say:

Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.

After the "Trisagion prayers", it is usual to pray the sequence below *(with bows or prostrations)*:

Lord, have mercy. *(12 times - in church, the reader says "Lord of mercy" 12 times in a row, without any bows or prostrations)*

[I do a prostration after every set of 3 "Lord have mercies", which looks like this:

Lord, have mercy, Lord, have mercy, Lord, have mercy *(prostration)*

Lord, have mercy, Lord, have mercy, Lord, have mercy *(prostration)*

Lord, have mercy, Lord, have mercy, Lord, have mercy *(prostration)*]

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever and unto the ages of ages, amen.
(bow or prostration)

O come, let us worship God our King. *(bow or prostration)*

O come, let us worship and fall down before Christ our King and God. *(bow or prostration)*

O come, let us worship and fall down before Christ Himself, our King and God. *(bow or prostration)*

After this, I strongly recommend you say the 50th Psalm and the Symbol of Faith. It is very important for a Christian to memorize these prayers or at least to be highly familiar with them. The 50th Psalm is one that we should definitely say every day. It is a psalm that entails the entire process of repentance.

Psalm 50:

Have mercy on me, O God, according to Thy great mercy; and according to the multitude of Thy compassions blot out my transgression.

Wash me thoroughly from mine iniquity and cleanse me from my sin.

For I know mine iniquity, and my sin is ever before me.

Against Thee only have I sinned and done this evil before Thee, that Thou mightest be justified in Thy words, and prevail when Thou art judged.

For behold, I was conceived in iniquities, and in sins did my mother bear me.

For behold, Thou hast loved truth; the hidden and secret things of Thy wisdom hast Thou made manifest unto me.

Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop, and I shall be made clean; Thou shalt wash me, and I shall be made whiter than snow.

Thou shalt make me to hear joy and gladness; the bones that be humbled, they shall rejoice.

Turn Thy face away from my sins and blot out all mine iniquities.

Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a right spirit within me.

Cast me not away from Thy presence and take not Thy Holy Spirit from me.

Restore unto me the joy of Thy salvation, and with Thy Governing Spirit establish me.

I shall teach transgressors Thy ways, and the ungodly shall turn back unto Thee.

Deliver me from blood-guiltiness, O God, Thou God of my salvation; my tongue shall rejoice in Thy righteousness.

O Lord, thou shalt open my lips, and my mouth shall declare Thy praise.

For if Thou hadst desired sacrifice, I had given it; with whole-burnt offerings Thou shalt not be pleased.

A sacrifice unto God is a broken spirit; a heart that is broken and humbled God will not despise.

Do good, O Lord, in Thy good pleasure unto Zion, and let the walls of Jerusalem be builded.

Then shalt Thou be pleased with a sacrifice of righteousness, with oblation and whole-burnt offerings.

Then shall they offer bullocks upon Thine altar.

Symbol of Faith:

I believe in one God, the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and the earth and of all things visible and invisible.

And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God, the Only-begotten, begotten of the Father before all ages; Light of Light, true God of true God; begotten, not made; of one essence with the Father, by Whom all things were made; Who for us men and for our salvation came down from the heavens, and was incarnate of the Holy Spirit and the Virgin Mary, and became man; And was crucified for us under Pontius Pilate, and suffered and was buried; And arose again on the third day according to the Scriptures; And ascended into the heavens, and sitteth at the right hand of the Father; And shall come again, with glory, to judge both the living and the dead; Whose kingdom shall

have no end. And in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the Giver of life; Who proceedeth from the Father; Who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified; Who spake by the prophets. In One, Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic Church. I confess one baptism for the remission of sins. I look for the resurrection of the dead, And the life of the age to come. Amen.

This entire beginning sequence (the “Trisagion prayers”, the “O Come let us worship” sequence, and Psalm 50 and the Symbol of Faith is at the beginning of the Morning Prayers. Don’t get caught up with figuring out how many prostrations or bows to do. Just try to say the prayers with attention! If you can do them with bows or prostrations, that’s good! The most important thing is to pray them slowly, with attention. There is marvelous theology in all of these prayers, and we would not know everything about them if we studied them for our entire lifetime.

In conclusion, I offer the following advice regarding reading the Psalter.

1. Read with purpose. Our purpose is to acquire the mind of Christ. The mind of Christ is in the prayers of the Psalter.
2. Read from a good translation of the Psalter and use a liturgical Psalter as the Orthodox Church uses it.
3. Read the Psalter in some kind of sequence so that you read all of the Psalms, and then begin reading from the beginning again.

4. If there are certain Psalms that you truly love, you can always read them every day!
5. You should definitely read the 50th Psalm every day.
6. It is good to begin reading the Psalter by a short rule of prayer which includes the “Trisagion Prayers,” a sequence including the prayer “O come let us worship...”, the 50th Psalm, and the Symbol of faith.

If you want to read the Psalter and you are tired and don’t want to do the beginning sequence, then just start reading the Psalter! None of these things is a straitjacket or something absolute that you must do, or else the prayer is not official or not acceptable. The only thing that makes our prayer not acceptable is when we do not pray with attention. And even our inattentive prayer, God accepts because he knows that we are weak and that He can help us to become strong.

I get questions from inquirers and catechumens and sometimes even people from across the world pretty often. I try to answer these questions personally, but sometimes the question is one that I think needs to be answered in a way that more people can see it. Sometimes, I answer the question with a letter or audio/video. I ensure that the question does not point back to the author of the question and maintains the anonymity of the questioner. I will try to answer any questions. Priest Seraphim Holland Phone/Telegram/Whatsapp: 972 658-5433 Email:seraphim@orthodox.net

Recent Stuff:

[Parable of the Wedding Feast. One of the meanings is to us directly and is an instruction on how to be saved.](http://www.orthodox.net/sermons/pen-sun-14_2022+wedding-feast.mp3)

http://www.orthodox.net/sermons/pen-sun-14_2022+wedding-feast.mp3

Commentary on the Parable of the wedding feast, from Matthew 22:1-14. It has an apparent meaning and a deeper spiritual meaning which is an instruction manual in how to be saved.

Partial timestamps

0:00 – 0:22 How many levels of meaning are in the Scripture?

0:22 – 0:54 Different levels of meaning in the Parable of the Wedding Feast.

0:54 The most apparent meaning of the Parable – concerning the Jews and Gentiles.

1:16 – 1:38 Concerning the “Kingdom of Heaven” parables.

1:38 “The Kingdom of heaven is like unto a certain king...” Meanings of the king, his son, and the marriage of his son

1:51 – 3:18 “And sent forth his servants to call them that were bidden to the wedding...” Concerning the double calling, and who did the calling. Another meaning of the wedding.

3:18 – 6:07 Concerning the *core reason* for the excuses (we should take note!): “But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his farm, another to his merchandise.” And much more about the nature of the marriage feast.

6:24 – 8:08 “But when the king heard thereof, he was wroth: and he sent forth his armies, and destroyed those murderers, and burned up their city.” The terrible destruction from sin. And about Hell.

8:08 – 12:21 “Go ye therefore into the highways, and as many as ye shall find, bid to the marriage” The calling of the Gentiles. And, from another similar parable “Compel them to come in.” What is this compelling? You *must* have this compelling within yourself, from yourself!

14:35 – 17:06 Meaning of: “12 And he saith unto him, Friend, how camest thou in hither not having a wedding garment? And he was speechless.” And about the advocacy of the saints and our guardian angel for us when *we* are speechless (and we will be!).

17:06 – 20:05 “13 Then said the king to the servants, Bind him hand and foot, and take him away, and cast him into outer darkness, there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

New Martyrs Angelis and Polydorus: we need examples of saints that did not do everything right before their martyrdom, because we don't do everything right!

Video: <https://youtu.be/1uaVSRXMXFs>

Audio: http://www.orthodox.net/sermons/saints-09-01_2022+nm-angelis+nm-polydorus.mp3

The New Martyrs of the Turkish Yoke, Angelis (+09-01-1680) and Polydorus (+09-03-1794) did not do everything right before their martyrdom, and they are therefore marvelous examples and intercessors for us, who get a lot wrong too! We can overcome any mistake with God's grace, adding to our resolve to repent even apostasy brought on by drunkenness.

3:30 - 7:39 NM Angelis

6:28 – 7:39 and 12:10-12:56 Why should we concern ourselves with former apostate martyrs and not just the ones who never wavered in their confession?

7:39 -12:56 NM Polydorus

Which person are you most like in the story of the beheading of John the Baptist?

http://www.orthodox.net/sermons/saints-08-28_2022+beheading-john-the-baptist.mp3

The story of the beheading of John the Baptist is one of triumph and much tragedy. The great tragedy is that everyone in the story except St. John perished. He was the only one who triumphed. We look at all of the characters in the story, the Baptist himself, Herod, his wife Herodias, her daughter Salome, and the sycophants who were silent as they drank Herod's wine and ate his food. We should examine each of them closely to see of which we are the most similar.

Partial Timestamps

0:00 – 16:11 [Can a government make a proclamation of independence from the ruling hierarch of the Orthodox church in their country?](#)

16:11

Can a government make a proclamation of independence from the ruling hierarch of the Orthodox church in their country?

Video: https://youtu.be/_jbKWx5nndA

Video: <https://rumble.com/v1juit9-can-a-government-proclaim-independence-from-the-ruling-hierarch-of-the-church.html>

Audio: http://www.orthodox.net/sermons/misc_2022-09-11+latvian-government-proclaims-independence-from-russian-church.mp3

A question from our catechism class: “Does the Latvian government have the authority to declare independence of the Latvian Orthodox Church from the Moscow?” As is our custom, we answer much more than just this question. This is a question of who we are and to whom we should be obedient. It is a question of when we should disobey our bishop and separate from him. It is a question of who should we be praying for and should we be praying for one or another combatant to be victorious in Ukraine or should we be praying for a stable peace as God desires it? What are the dangers to the church in Ukraine, that is the true Orthodox Christians in Ukraine? What can the little guy do?

As is always the case in any question about world politics or anything that happens in the world, our personal reaction to it must be a spiritual one first and must involve prayer for those we support in those we oppose. Every church should be praying for both Ukraine and Russia. Especially Ukrainian churches should be praying for Russia as well as their country, and Russian churches can be praying for Ukraine as well as their country. We also, from her tiny little pulpit, patriarch Curiel and Metropolitan Onuphrius to get together and concelebrate the liturgy as brothers, and not allow political rhetoric and the fog of war to obscure the fact that they are in brothers.

Martyrs Adrian and Natalia: Perfection with imperfect steps. Comm Aug 26

http://www.orthodox.net/sermons/saints-08-26_2022+martyrs-adrian-and-natalia.mp3

The glorious “bloodless” martyr Natalia was a secret Christian, and married to a pagan! And her husband Adrian became inspired by the exploits, endurance, and dignity of Christians being martyred, and she then made known to him her Christianity and assisted him during his martyrdom in an intimate way. We talk about this, how perfection came from imperfect beginnings. Len 9:23

Baptism of Iwerddd (pronounced: Oo-airith)/ Aerith: What did we do and why? What was symbolic or actual? Why the incarnation? What should we do now?

Video: <https://youtu.be/iA9vk8Gm5X0>

Video: <https://rumble.com/v1iz87l-baptism-of-erith-what-did-we-do-and-why-what-was-symbolic-or-actual-why-the.html>

Audio: <http://www.orthodox.net/sermons/baptism-2022+iwerddd+overview-of-baptism-the-incarnation-our-purpose.mp3>

Timestamps:

0:00 – 1:26 Symbolism of churching the infant and leaving her on the ground before the royal doors.

1:26 – 4:35 What did we do today? Why did Jesus become incarnate, And what is spiritual death?

1:56 What does this mean: “Gen 3:3 But of the fruit of the tree which is in the midst of the garden, God hath said, Ye shall not eat of it, neither shall ye touch it, lest ye die.”

16:11 – 07:16 What Erith's purpose?

07:16 – 08:18 What symbolically and actually happened in Erith's baptism?

8:18 – 08:47 What is symbolic and actual about processing 3 times around the font during the baptism service

The Dormition of the Theotokos. Another lesson about the power of the resurrection.

Video: <https://youtu.be/Fm4RASgyRC0>

What is the Dormition, and does this feast apply to *us*? It is impossible to understand the incarnation and the resurrection without understanding the role of Mary. Why do we believe the Dormition is true? How was the bible written? Why do we call Mary the Theotokos? Exegesis of the Magnificat, which is partially read on feasts of Mary, the Theotokos.

Partial timestamps:

00:00 – 01:35 Meaning of “Dormition” – regarding the Feast of the Dormition and Christian experience after the resurrection

01:35 – 03:51 Why do we believe the Dormition is true? How was the bible written? What is the main way the church teaches her children?

03:51 – 6:23 and 10:30 – 11:34 Meaning of the word “Theotokos”, and “Christotokos”, and why the distinction is important. And whether or not we should be well educated on all the heresies regarding the incarnation.

6:23 – 10:30 A short explanation of the reason for the incarnation.

11:33 – 13:04 Why is the supper with Mary and Martha read on feasts of the Theotokos?

15:10 – 19:35 “And it came to pass, that, when Elisabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the babe leaped in her womb;”

19:35 – end The “Magnificat”

20:55 – 24:53 “And Mary said, My soul doth magnify the Lord, And my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Saviour. For he hath regarded the low estate of his slave: for, behold, from henceforth all generations shall call me blessed. For he that is mighty hath done to me great things; and holy is his name.”

(Luke 1:46-49)

24:53 “And his mercy is on them that fear him from generation to generation.” (Luke 1:50)

¹ Matthew 11:12 And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven suffereth violence, and the violent take it by force.